The Harry and Sam Dialogues

By Karen Ellison

Character: Harry and Sam (30-40), a couple of regular guys.
Scene: Here and Now: Harry and Sam have been best friends for 20 years. Here, they engage in idle, yet imaginative, banter while shooting pool.

INTRODUCTION

Sam: ***Harry and Sam are old friends who like to pass the time posing outlandish questions to one another.***

Harry: ***"If ya' had the choice would ya' rather love a woman whose top half was a fish and whose bottom half was a woman or a woman whose top half was a woman and whose bottom half was a fish?"***

Sam: ***See what I mean?***

Together: The Harry and Sam Dialogues by Karen Ellison

(Fade in. McDougal's Bar, Harry and Sam's hangout. Harry and Sam play pool. Two stools sit nearby.)

HARRY: Say ya' gotta tree.

SAM: I gotta tree.

HARRY: Ya' gotta whole forest 'a trees.

SAM: I gotta whole forest 'a trees.

HARRY: Now say there's only one person for miles around-a guy with one of those red and black jackets and a ski hat with an axe...

SAM: A lumberjack.

HARRY: Whatever. And he's chopping one 'a your trees. But he only chopped part way.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

SAM: Gotcha.

HARRY: Now he's pulling out his lunch pail.

SAM: A red one?

HARRY: Yeah.

SAM: Like yours?

HARRY: Yeah.

SAM: (Fondly.) With the matching thermos?

HARRY: Yeah! Okay! And he's starting to eat.

SAM: Lunch.

HARRY: Yeah. So this guy-this tree chopper-while he's eating his lunch, he gets a call on his beeper.

SAM: He gotta beeper?

HARRY: Yeah.

SAM: This lumberjack, in the middle 'a the woods using an ax to chop a tree, has a beeper.

HARRY: Yeah, he has a beeper! He's part of a large tree chopping corporation.

SAM: Timber mill.

HARRY: Whatever. So this guy gets a call on his beeper. He pulls out his cellular phone- (Harry gives Sam a look.) 'cause there's no phone booth in the woods...

SAM: 'Course.

HARRY: ...And he calls the number that flashed on his beeper, and the guy on the other end says, "Come on over to the plant, quick! Your wife's having a baby!"

SAM: At the plant?

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

HARRY: No, not at the plant. At the hospital!

SAM: The lumberjack-he know about this?

HARRY: What?

SAM: He know his wife's gonna have a baby?

HARRY: Yeah! 'Course he knows!

SAM: 'Cause the way you said in, "Come on over, Your wife's having a baby," sounds like it's a surprise.

HARRY: 'Course he knows about it. He whaddaya'-call-it-helped!

SAM: He knew she was pregnant?

HARRY: Yeah, Sam. He knew she was pregnant.

SAM: She wasn't keeping it from him?

HARRY: She's as big as a house, for Christ's sake!

SAM: Don't curse. He hasn't maybe been out of town for nine months chopping trees in the... Black Forest, say?

HARRY: No! He works about fifteen miles from home.

SAM: Fifteen miles.

HARRY: Yeah. (Sam writes something down. Harry looks over his shoulder.)

SAM: What's his wife's name?

HARRY: Doesn't matter what his wife's name is!

SAM: Just thought it might be important.

HARRY: It isn't. Trust me. So, anyway, this tree chopper puts down his lunch...

SAM: What's he eating?

HARRY: What?

SAM: What's he eating for lunch?

HARRY: It doesn't matter what he's eating for lunch.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

SAM: How do I know? How do I know it doesn't matter? What if you're going to ask me the contents of his stomach when they pump it during the autopsy after his car is pushed off a cliff by an eighteen wheeler driven by Yahn and Eric, the perpetrators of the tax fraud that the young lumberjack, Yom van Yom, was going to expose at Shady Pines, the timber mill where he works? It could be important! Everything's important to me now, Harry, because I don't know, do I? And sure. Sure you'll say, "Trust me." Trust you? Like the time you were telling that joke to the lodge about the porpoise and the prostitute, only you left out that part about. .

HARRY: Salad.

SAM: Salad?

HARRY: He's eating salad for lunch, and then the tree chopper runs to his pickup truck and drives off to his wife whose name doesn't matter who's having a baby at the hospital.

SAM: Natural or cesarean?

HARRY: How should I know what kind salad it was? So, anyway, while the tree chopper is at the hospital, this one tree that he chopped part way, remember?

SAM: I remember.

HARRY: 'Cause it was sometime ago that I mentioned that.

SAM: I remember.

HARRY: This one tree falls down.

SAM: Lawsuit!

HARRY: No lawsuit!

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

SAM: It lands on someone's car!

HARRY: Who's telling this story? No. There's nothing and no one around for miles. Just trees.

SAM: Trees.

HARRY: Trees. So?

SAM: So?

HARRY: When the tree hits the ground, does it make any kind 'a noise?

SAM: Let me get this straight: if a tree falls in the forest, and no one's there to hear it, does it make a sound?

HARRY: Well... yeah. That's another way to say it.

SAM: No.

HARRY: What?

SAM: No. (Indicating pool table.) It's your shot. (Harry puts his hand to his back.) You okay?

HARRY: Had to sleep on the end of the bed. Ya' don't want time to think about it?

SAM: No. She made ya' do that? Ballbuster.

HARRY: I'11 give ya' a couple minutes.

SAM: Don't need time. The answer is still no.

HARRY: No, huh?

SAM: No.

HARRY: Ya' don't want to ask me some questions?

SAM: No.

HARRY: Like are there any animals in the forest?

SAM: No.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

HARRY: Maybe ya' want to ask me what's on the ground in the forest?

SAM: No.

HARRY: Grass?

SAM: No.

HARRY: Dirt?

SAM: No.

HARRY: Moss?

SAM: No.

HARRY: Moose goo?

SAM: No.

HARRY: No sound?

SAM: No sound. (Pause.)

HARRY: Well, this really stinks. I mean this eats it. You're not playing along!

SAM: Ya' asked me a question, I answered. (Smug.) Go ahead. Ask me another. (Pause.)

HARRY: Okay. It's the beginning of time, and there's this big red barn owned by Caveman Farmer Wilson. ..

SAM: Cut to the chase.

HARRY: Okay. Whi...

SAM: The egg. (Pause. The following exchange takes place fast andfurious.)

HARRY: Is there life after death?

SAM: No.

HARRY: Who built the pyramids?

SAM: Martians.

HARRY: What is Stonehenge?

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

SAM: Primitive wristwatch - made by Martians.

HARRY: Why can't ya' get a good five cent cigar?

SAM: Recession.

HARRY: What do vice presidents do?

SAM: Wait for someone to die.

HARRY: What is Bigfoot?

SAM: Giant gorilla-man from Mars.

HARRY: Where is Jimmy Hoffa?

SAM: Yankee Stadium, left field, seats 3A through D.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Karen Ellison
ISBN: 082221380X
Publisher: Dramatists Play Service, Inc.
Date (Month/Year): Jan 1994

AWARDS

2003 National Qualifier
2010 National Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY